
Concerns regarding the proposed data center in Callaway County

From Candace Latham <clatham@ktis.net>

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To Curt Warfield <cwarfield@callawaycounty.org>; Gary Jungermann <GJungermann@Callawaycounty.org>;
Christopher Scott <cscott@callawaycounty.org>

Good afternoon,

I would like to share my concerns regarding the proposed data center development in Callaway County. Although I understand the importance of attracting new business and investment, I do not believe this project is the right fit for our community in its current form.

There are several issues that I feel deserve closer attention before any approvals move forward:

1. Environmental Concerns – Large-scale data centers can consume enormous amounts of water and create ongoing noise from cooling equipment and backup generators, which may negatively affect nearby residents and wildlife.
2. Energy Demand – The substantial electricity requirements associated with these facilities could place added strain on the power grid and potentially increase utility costs for local households.
3. Community and Land Impact – Callaway County's rural character and agricultural landscape are important to many residents. A project of this scale could permanently alter the area and disrupt farmland and natural habitats.

While tax revenue and economic growth are often cited as benefits, developments of this magnitude should be held to strict standards to ensure they do not negatively impact surrounding communities.

At a minimum, I encourage the commission to consider the following safeguards:

- Strong noise-control requirements to limit disturbance to neighboring properties.
- Restrictions against construction in flood-prone areas or locations with sensitive water resources.
- Oversight of water and power consumption to protect availability and affordability for local residents.
- An independent study examining possible heat-related effects on nearby farmland and agriculture.

I respectfully ask the commission to either deny this proposal or delay consideration until a full environmental and community impact review can be completed.

Thank you for your time and consideration.

Sincerely,

Candace Latham
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